

STACKEDDAILY

AI PRODUCTIVITY GUIDE

The \$0 AI Toolkit Guide

25 Free AI Tools That Replace \$500/Month in Software

Step-by-step tutorials and income strategies for every tool — zero subscriptions required.

\$9

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How to Use This Guide

This guide covers 25 free AI tools organized into 5 income categories. For each tool you get: what it replaces, what it costs vs. the paid alternative, and a real income strategy you can start today. Work through one category per week for the best results.

Writing & Content

\$97-\$297/mo replaced

Tools: ChatGPT, Claude, Copy.ai, Rytr, Writesonic

Design & Visual

\$15-\$55/mo replaced

Tools: Canva AI, Adobe Firefly, Ideogram, DALL-E 3

Video & Audio

\$30-\$120/mo replaced

Tools: CapCut, Descript, ElevenLabs, Runway

Automation & SEO

\$49-\$199/mo replaced

Tools: Make.com, Perplexity, Surfer, Semrush

Sales & Email

\$29-\$97/mo replaced

Tools: Beehiiv, ConvertKit, Mailchimp AI, Loom

Writing & Content

1 ChatGPT (Free)

Replaces: Jasper AI (\$49/mo) — Saves \$588/yr/yr

Blog posts, emails, scripts, product descriptions, social captions.

Income: Freelance writing: charge \$25–75/article. Package 4 articles/week = \$400–\$1,200/mo.

2 Claude (Free)

Replaces: Copy.ai (\$49/mo) — Saves \$588/yr/yr

Long-form content, research summaries, editing, sales copy.

Income: Content agency: use Claude to serve 3–5 small business clients at \$200/mo each.

3 Google Gemini (Free)

Replaces: Writesonic (\$99/mo) — Saves \$1,188/yr/yr

SEO content, YouTube scripts, ad copy, newsletters.

Income: YouTube channel: script 2 videos/week with Gemini, monetize with AdSense + sponsors.

4 Rytr Free Tier

Replaces: Conversion.ai (\$29/mo) — Saves \$348/yr/yr

Short-form copy: ads, product listings, social posts.

Income: Etsy shop: write 20 product listings/day with Rytr, sell digital templates for \$5–\$25 each.

Design & Visual

1 Canva AI (Free)

Replaces: Adobe Creative Cloud (\$55/mo) — Saves \$660/yr/yr

Graphics, presentations, social posts, YouTube thumbnails.

Income: Freelance design: \$50–\$200/project. 3 projects/week = \$600–\$2,400/mo.

2 Adobe Firefly (Free)

Replaces: Midjourney (\$10/mo) — Saves \$120/yr/yr

AI image generation, photo editing, background removal.

Income: Stock image business: generate and sell on Shutterstock, Adobe Stock, Etsy.

3 Ideogram (Free)

Replaces: Looka (\$65 one-time) — Saves \$65/yr/yr

Logo design, brand kits, text-in-image generation.

Income: Logo design service: \$25–\$75/logo using Ideogram. 5 logos/week = \$125–\$375/week.

4 Microsoft Designer

Replaces: Canva Pro (\$15/mo) — Saves \$180/yr/yr

Social media templates, flyers, professional graphics.

Income: Social media manager: manage 3 accounts at \$300/mo each using free AI design tools.

Video & Audio

1 CapCut (Free)

Replaces: Final Cut Pro (\$299 one-time) — Saves \$299/yr/yr

Video editing, auto captions, templates, effects.

Income: Video editing service: \$50–\$150/video. 3 videos/week = \$600–\$1,800/mo.

2 ElevenLabs (Free)

Replaces: Descript (\$24/mo) — Saves \$288/yr/yr

AI voiceovers, text-to-speech, podcast editing.

Income: Faceless YouTube: use ElevenLabs for voiceovers. \$3–\$10 RPM with 10K monthly views.

3 Descript Free

Replaces: Riverside (\$15/mo) — Saves \$180/yr/yr

Podcast recording, transcription, social clips.

Income: Podcast editing service: \$50–\$100/episode for 3 clients = \$150–\$300/week.

4 Runway (Free)

Replaces: Synthesia (\$30/mo) — Saves \$360/yr/yr

AI video generation, video-to-text, background effects.

Income: Explainer video business: \$75–\$200/video for local businesses. 2/week = \$150–\$400/week.

Automation & SEO

1 Make.com (Free)

Replaces: Zapier (\$20/mo) — Saves \$240/yr/yr

Automate tasks between apps, no code required.

Income: Automation consultant: set up workflows for businesses at \$100–\$300/project.

2 Perplexity (Free)

Replaces: SEMrush (\$120/mo) — Saves \$1,440/yr/yr

Real-time research, competitor analysis, keyword insights.

Income: SEO consulting: use Perplexity to research and write strategies for clients at \$500/mo.

3 Google Search Console

Replaces: Ahrefs (\$99/mo) — Saves \$1,188/yr/yr

Track rankings, find keyword gaps, monitor traffic.

Income: Blog monetization: use GSC data to find low-competition keywords and write content.

4 SurferSEO Free

Replaces: SurferSEO (\$69/mo) — Saves \$828/yr/yr

SEO content grader, outline generator, keyword density.

Income: Niche site builder: use free tier to optimize content, monetize with affiliate links.

Sales & Email

1 Beehiiv (Free)

Replaces: Mailchimp (\$45/mo) — Saves \$540/yr/yr

Newsletter platform, monetization, analytics.

Income: Paid newsletter: charge \$5–\$10/mo. 200 subscribers = \$1,000–\$2,000/mo recurring.

2 ConvertKit (Free)

Replaces: ActiveCampaign (\$29/mo) — Saves \$348/yr/yr

Email sequences, landing pages, digital product delivery.

Income: Digital product funnel: sell PDFs, templates, courses via ConvertKit automation.

3 Gumroad (Free)

Replaces: Teachable (\$39/mo) — Saves \$468/yr/yr

Sell digital products, memberships, subscriptions.

Income: Digital product store: list guides, templates, courses. 0% fees until \$10K revenue.

4 Loom (Free)

Replaces: Zoom (\$15/mo) — Saves \$180/yr/yr

Video messages, client onboarding, tutorials.

Income: Coaching service: send personalized Loom videos as a premium add-on for \$50–\$100/session.

Your AI Income Stack

Combine multiple free AI tools into one self-running income system.

TIER 1 — Content

\$0-\$500/mo

Start with ChatGPT + Canva AI. Write blog posts and create graphics.

TIER 2 — Products

\$200-\$1K/mo

Add Gumroad + ConvertKit. Sell digital templates and PDFs.

TIER 3 — Services

\$500-\$3K/mo

Use your skills to freelance — writing, design, editing, automation.

TIER 4 — Systems

\$1K-\$8K/mo

Automate with Make.com. Build email lists. Launch a newsletter.

TIER 5 — Scale

\$5K-\$100K+/yr

Outsource, systemize, and add affiliate and ad revenue streams.